Audit System Evolution

Architecture & Decision Brief

Executive Summary: Clarifying audit terminology, evaluating options for editing checkpoints/SOPs, and defining the right strategy for custom date-range analytics.

1. System Terminology: What is an SOP vs. a Checkpoint?

To ensure our business operations and software structure remain perfectly aligned, here is how the audit system is organized:

Concept	What It Means in Store Practice	Real Retail Examples in Your App
SOP (Standard Operating Procedure)	A broad operational pillar or management category. The app currently has **8 core SOP categories** (plus Operations).	SOP 1: Grooming SOP 6: Cash Management * SOP 7: Inventory Management *
Checkpoint	The individual, concrete inspection item under an SOP that the auditor physically inspects and marks as **Pass (P)**, **Fail (F)**, or **NA**.	1.1 Uniform clean & ironed 6.1 Safe cash matches system 7.6 High-value watches locked

How they work together during an audit

When Store Managers (Daily) or GMs (Weekly) run an audit, they go checkpoint by checkpoint. **A Pass** earns full points (1x or 2x weight); **a Fail** earns 0 points (and triggers a photo requirement for cash/inventory); and **NA** completely removes the item from the calculation so nobody is penalized for non-applicable situations.

2. Scope Question: Do You Want to Edit Checkpoints Only, or SOPs Too?

As we make the system customizable, we need to know how far you want this flexibility to go:

Scope Level	What You Would Be Able to Do	Operational & Technical Impact
Level A: Checkpoints Only	The core SOP categories remain fixed (Grooming, Cash, Inventory, etc.), but inside them, you can add new inspection questions, edit text/Marathi translations, change weights (1x vs 2x), or disable outdated checkpoints anytime.	**Low Risk & Seamless.** 100% preserves your historical compliance trend charts, rolling averages, and store manager performance baselines.
Level B: Both SOPs & Checkpoints (Full Freedom)	In addition to editing checkpoints, you can also create brand-new SOP categories (e.g. 'SOP 10: Customer Hospitality') or delete existing SOP categories entirely.	**Higher Complexity.** Adding or deleting whole SOPs requires dynamic dashboard cards, report layout restructuring, and mapping past audit archives.

3. How Should Updates Be Made: Mobile App vs. Excel Import?

You requested the ability to manage checkpoints via Excel. As software engineers, our primary duty is to ensure you get maximum convenience without any risk of database crashes, file corruption, or loss of historical audit reports. Here is how the three approaches compare:

Operational Use Case	Option 1: In-App Mobile UI	Option 2: Excel Import ONLY	Option 3: Hybrid
Quick Single-Item Edits (e.g., fix a typo in 1 checkpoint)	**10 seconds:** Tap checkpoint, fix word, tap save on phone.	**Cumbersome:** Export sheet, open in PC/Excel, edit, re-upload.	**Yes:** Fast in-app tap for instant single-item edits.
Disabling an Item (e.g., stop checking gloves)	**1 tap:** Flip switch from Active to Inactive.	**Extra work:** Must delete the row from Excel and re-upload.	**Yes:** Instant 1-tap active/inactive toggle.
Major Bulk Revamp (e.g., rewriting 30+ items at once)	**Tedious** on a mobile touchscreen.	**Super fast on PC:** Copy-paste, mass edit in Excel.	**Yes:** Download template, mass edit in Excel, upload.
Data Safety & Error Prevention	**100% Safe:** Real-time checks prevent invalid data entry.	**Risk of user error:** Corrupted headers or blank cells can fail import.	**Protected:** App validates all rows before applying any updates.
Mobile Independence	**Works anywhere** on your phone with zero extra apps.	**Requires** PC or a mobile spreadsheet viewer installed.	**Best of both:** Phone for quick fixes, PC for big overhauls.

How Option 3 (The Hybrid Engine) Works

Note: an Excel Importer cannot safely operate without an underlying in-app data engine, so Options 2 and 3 both rely on one. Here is how the Hybrid option (Option 3) would work:

- **On your phone:** a clean **Manage Checkpoints** screen under Settings where you can toggle any checkpoint ON/OFF or edit text in 5 seconds.
- **Bulk edits:** at the top of that same screen, two buttons - **[Export Template (.xlsx)]** and **[Import Excel]**. Whenever you want to re-architect SOPs in bulk from your laptop, download the sheet, edit in Excel, and upload.
- **Past Audits Protection:** when you remove an item in Excel or in the app, the system performs a 'Soft Delete' (`is_active = 0`). It disappears from future audits, but all historical audit reports and compliance percentages remain 100% accurate.

4. Arbitrary Date-Range Audits: Operational Analysis

You also asked whether an Admin could create an audit covering any arbitrary date range (e.g. running a single audit for 5 days or 18 days). After careful operational analysis, here is the operational reasoning on arbitrary date-range audit execution:

Why 'Date-Range Audits' conflict with store compliance reality

- **Auditing is a same-day physical observation:** Checkpoints inspect physical reality right now. For example, Checkpoint 1.1 checks 'Is uniform ironed today?', Checkpoint 2.1 checks 'Was the store opening photo taken at 10:30 AM?', and Checkpoint 6.1 checks 'Does the physical cash drawer match the POS register tonight?'. You cannot physically mark grooming or cash drawer balance for 'last Wednesday through next Tuesday' on a single checklist.
- **Prevents Store Managers from slacking:** The primary strength of your audit system is daily accountability. If a date-range audit is allowed, staff will inevitably skip daily checks and try to backfill an entire week's audit in 10 minutes on Sunday night, destroying honest store discipline.
- **Titan World & Helios corporate hierarchy:** Corporate retail relies on a strict verification chain, shown below.

Daily
Closing checks
(Store Manager)
>
Weekly
Verification & bank audits
(GM)
>
Monthly
Strategic governance
(Owner)

5. Owner Decision & Feedback Sheet

Please indicate your preference below so our engineering team can build exactly what suits your daily routine:

Decision Item	Options (Please Tick Your Choice)	Owner Notes / Specific Instructions
1. Management Scope	[ ] **Level A:** Checkpoints only within fixed SOPs. [ ] **Level B:** Full freedom to add/delete entire SOPs too.	
2. Interface Preference	[ ] **Option 3:** Hybrid (In-App Editor + Excel Import/Export). [ ] **Option 2:** Excel Import/Export ONLY. [ ] **Option 1:** In-App Mobile Screen ONLY.	
3. Date-Range Handling	[ ] Keep Daily/Weekly/Monthly audit execution intact (no arbitrary date-range audits).	

Reviewed & Decided By: _____ (Store Owner / Management) **Date:** ____ / ____ / 2026